

Ali Rayyan

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SUMMARY

Aspiring cybersecurity professional with apprentice-level experience in SOC analysis and blue team research. Enhanced SOC efficiency by optimizing threat detection workflows and automated incident response, and improved malware detection through strategic analysis and rule implementation. Eager to leverage hands-on security experience to fortify systems against dynamic cyber threats and advance organizational defense strategies.

EDUCATION

BS, Software Engineering 2023 – 2027

Government College University, Faisalabad | Pakistan

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

SOC Analyst Intern – Blue Team March 2026 – May 2026

Cyberster | Remote

- Deployed Wazuh 4.14 SIEM across a 4-VM VMware lab and wrote 3 custom detection rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK;(T1110 SSH brute force, T1136 account creation, T1548.003 sudo escalation) with frequency-based correlation, reducing mean-time-to-detect for brute force attacks from manual inspection to an automated 120-second threshold trigger.
- Integrated FortiGate VM as a network perimeter firewall routing all inter-VM traffic through logged policies; resolved a UDP514 port conflict between Wazuh and rsyslog by configuring a secondary syslog server on port 5140, achieving centralised FortiGate traffic log ingestion into the Wazuh dashboard.
- Executed a full insider threat simulation as both red team (certutil Base64 encoding, PowerShell HTTP POST exfiltration, Remove-Item anti-forensic cleanup) and blue team (Wazuh FIM Rules 553/554, CyberChef payload decoding), confirming SIEM evidence survived the attacker's deletion and producing a NIST SP 800-61 incident response report.
- Performed static and dynamic malware analysis on njRAT and Win32.Infostealer.Dexter using strings, exiftool, binwalk, and Hybrid Analysis sandbox, extracting 14 IOCs and writing 4 custom Suricata signatures and 4 Wazuh host-based rules derived from observed TTPs.
- Conducted digital forensics investigations across 3 simulated cases (Mantooth fraud, M57.biz phishing, Jo memory forensics) using Autopsy, FTK Imager, EvtxECmd, and Volatility 3 — reconstructed a definitive 11-event super timeline proving social engineering rather than insider threat in the M57.biz case, and performed memory analysis on a Windows XP SP3 RAM image to identify live acquisition processes, process injection indicators, and OpenOffice macro execution behaviour.

Cybersecurity Threat Research Intern March 2026 – April 2026

Tech Hierarchy | Remote

- Conducted in-depth threat research on major cybersecurity incidents including the FBR Tax Fraud Breach, TPS Ransomware Attack, and MOVEit Zero-Day (CVE-2023-34362), producing a multi-incident report with CIA triad analysis and comparative summary tables.
- Mapped adversary tactics, techniques, and procedures (TTPs) to the MITRE ATT&CK framework for each incident, deriving actionable threat intelligence and lessons learned for organizational defense.
- Analyzed the business and operational impact of each breach, identifying security gaps and recommending mitigation strategies aligned with industry best practices.

Cybersecurity Analyst Dec 2025 – Feb 2026

Talosec | Remote

- Designed and deployed an enterprise SOC virtual lab using VMware, integrating FortiGate firewall, Windows Server ActiveDirectory, and Wazuh SIEM — simulating real-world network security architecture for blue team training and threat detection operations.
- Configured FortiGate firewall with multi-zone network segmentation (WAN, LAN, Server/SOC), implementing firewall policies and syslog forwarding to enable centralized traffic monitoring and log correlation across all network zones.
- Deployed Wazuh SIEM with custom detection rules for network reconnaissance and brute-force attacks, configured active response mechanisms, and built security dashboards — achieving real-time visibility across 4 endpoints and 100% detection of simulated authentication attacks.
- Analyzed Ubuntu server logs and investigated honeypot data to identify attacker TTPs aligned with MITRE ATT&CK; improving threat detection accuracy and SOC incident response readiness.

SOC Analyst Apprentice Jun 2025 – Aug 2025

Empirical Training | United Kingdom, Greater London

- Investigated security alerts and optimized detection workflows in Microsoft Sentinel and Sumo Logic labs, improving incident triage efficiency.
- Performed vulnerability scans with Nessus and Nmap, leveraging CVSS scoring to prioritize remediation.
- Queried and correlated logs using KQL in Sentinel to enhance security event analysis.
- Built a custom Elastic SIEM rule with automated response via Tines AI workflows.
- Developed a phishing email analysis tool using Sublime Security with real-time threat notifications.
- Deployed Suricata IDS, honeypots, Canary Tokens, and lab simulations, identifying and logging 100+ simulated intrusion attempts to validate detection rules and enhance SOC incident readiness.
- Built and deployed an AI-driven threat intelligence automation pipeline using n8n and RSS feeds, reducing manual vulnerability monitoring time by 70% and enabling near real-time SOC analyst alerts.

PROJECTS

Tines Phishing Email Analysis Automation 2025

Empirical Training | Remote

- Built an automated phishing detection and triage workflow integrating Elastic SIEM, Tines, and Sublime Security for .eml email analysis.
- Automated email parsing, metadata extraction, and threat scoring, reducing manual triage time by 50%.

AI-Powered Threat Feed Summarization System 2025

Empirical Training | Remote

- Developed an automated CVE monitoring and summarization pipeline using n8n, OpenAI GPT-4, and public RSS feeds (CISA, NVD).
- Implemented AI-powered CVE summarization to convert raw vulnerability data into concise, actionable insights for SOC teams.

Cloud SIEM Investigation – Phishing to AWS Credential Exfiltration 2025

Sumo Logic

- Investigated a simulated SOC case in Cloud SIEM, correlating phishing email delivery, malicious link click, AWS API spikes, and GuardDuty alerts into a complete attack narrative.
- Identified credential theft via phishing, followed by AWS reconnaissance and IAM credential exfiltration, mapping activity to MITRE ATT&CK stages.
- Demonstrated ability to analyze multi-source logs (Proofpoint TAP, proxy, AWS CloudTrail, GuardDuty) to detect and respond to a full attack kill chain.

CERTIFICATIONS

- IBM Cybersecurity Professional Certificate — Coursera

- The Complete Cyber Security Course – Hackers Exposed! — Udemy
- Forage Job Simulations: Telstra, Mastercard, AIG, ANZ, Datacom, TATA

EXTRACURRICULAR

Community Contributor Feb 2025

CyberHub – SOC+

- Helped a community member resolve a non-functioning Tines AI workflow by identifying configuration errors, enabling successful output generation and restoring their automation process.
- Developed an AI-powered threat feed integration that improved real-time threat visibility for members, earning a pinned recognition from community admins for its usefulness.

Participant 2025

US Cyber Games – Season V

- Participated in the US Cyber Open Beginner's Game Room, gaining hands-on experience in network security, cryptography, and system exploitation — boosting practical competency across core blue team operations.
- Achieved 100% challenge completion rate in team-based challenges focused on threat detection, incident analysis, and real-time decision-making.

SKILLS

Wireshark · Nmap · Microsoft Sentinel · Tines · Sumo Logic · Wazuh · Elastic SIEM · PCAP Analysis · Cyber Kill Chain · MITRE

ATT&CK; · MITRE ATLAS · IOC Analysis · Python (Basic Scripting) · KQL · FortiGate · Fortinet · Incident Response · Alert Triage & Escalation · Vulnerability Assessment · Log Correlation & Investigation · n8n Automation · Autopsy · FTK Imager · Volatility 3 · Digital Forensics · TryHackMe · Critical Thinking · Risk Management · Teamwork